

INVESTMENT ANALYSIS · CONFIDENTIAL

# 1,000 Micro-SaaS Startups: Where the Revenue Actually Is

A data-driven investment memo on the TrustMRR universe — traction quality, monetisation, valuation dispersion and where capital is mispriced.

**\$334.0m**

all-time revenue

**\$13.5m**

aggregate MRR

**91%**

revenue in top 10%

**262**

assets for sale

Frozen dataset: 30 July 2026 · n = 1,000 startups · all figures USD

# How this deck is built: from raw file to investment decision

|    |                                                 |                                                     |
|----|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | <b>Data preparation &amp; assumptions</b>       | What we cleaned, dropped and inferred               |
| 02 | <b>Executive summary &amp; dashboard</b>        | The whole thesis on two pages                       |
| 03 | <b>Business performance</b>                     | Revenue, MRR, growth, traffic, monetisation quality |
| 04 | <b>Segment economics</b>                        | Providers, categories, pricing, personas, geography |
| 05 | <b>M&amp;A / for-sale market</b>                | 262 listed assets, multiples and mispricing         |
| 06 | <b>Correlations &amp; 25+ investor insights</b> | What actually predicts revenue                      |
| 07 | <b>Investment memo</b>                          | Ten bets and fifteen recommendations                |

# The file is usable — but 4 of 29 fields are too sparse to carry a thesis

- 1,000 unique record\_ids, zero duplicates removed; 129 shared names are genuine anonymised listings ("Stealth Company", "Hidden Business"), kept but excluded from named call-outs.
- Currency: every monetary field is already USD-denominated (revenue, MRR, asking price); no FX normalisation required. No negative money values found.
- Sentinel strings (PRICING\_NOT\_FOUND, "[Private metric ... after login]") converted to missing — otherwise they contaminate every text-based segmentation.
- revenue\_multiple stored as text ("2.3x") → parsed to numeric; we recompute an independent multiple = asking price ÷ trailing-12M revenue and use that for valuation work.
- Growth outliers: 7 records above +1,000% (max +7,900%). Winsorised at [-100%, +1,000%] for averages; medians used throughout as the headline statistic.
- Payment provider is multi-valued for 13 startups; we analyse the primary (first-listed) provider and flag multi-provider stacks separately.
- Free-text pricing\_model (615 unique strings) and target\_persona (603) normalised into 8 pricing archetypes and 13 persona clusters via keyword mapping.

**SO WHAT** Treat revenue, MRR and subscriptions as decision-grade; treat traffic, revenue-per-visitor and stated multiples as directional only — they exist for a self-selected minority.

# Coverage — not accuracy — is the binding constraint

| Field                          | Coverage | Missing | Investment read                                    |
|--------------------------------|----------|---------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Revenue / MRR / subscriptions  | 100%     | 0       | Decision-grade — full population                   |
| Revenue growth 30D             | 98.6%    | 14      | Decision-grade                                     |
| MRR growth 30D                 | 89.3%    | 107     | Usable; absence correlates with zero-MRR firms     |
| X followers                    | 98.4%    | 16      | Usable; 44% of firms have 0 followers              |
| Domain rating                  | 71.4%    | 286     | Directional — SEO-invisible firms often unmeasured |
| Country                        | 75.9%    | 241     | Directional — 24% of revenue geography unknown     |
| Category / audience / persona  | 72–73%   | 274–361 | Directional segmentation only                      |
| Asking price (of 262 for sale) | 99.6%    | 1       | Decision-grade within the listed subset            |
| Visitors 30D                   | 17.8%    | 822     | NOT decision-grade — self-reported minority        |
| Revenue per visitor            | 16.5%    | 858     | NOT decision-grade — derived from the above        |

- Structural zeros are real signal, not error: 216 startups (22%) booked \$0 in the last 30 days and 44% have zero social following.
- Assumption: absence of a field is informative (unlisted traffic skews to weak traffic), so we never impute — we report on the observed subset and state n.

**SO WHAT** Any thesis built on traffic or SEO data covers at most a fifth of the universe; underwrite on revenue, MRR and subscription counts, which are complete.

# A barbell market: ten companies own the economics, 900 are experiments

## Biggest finding

- Top 10% of startups hold 91% of all-time revenue and 82% of MRR; the bottom half holds 0.1%.
- Median startup: \$3,620 lifetime revenue, \$282 MRR — this is a hobby-project distribution with a venture tail.

## Key patterns

- Distribution beats product: revenue tracks subscriptions ( $\rho$  0.90) and traffic ( $\rho$  0.60) — not social following ( $\rho$  0.23).
- B2B monetises 5.7x better than B2C on median MRR (\$1,036 vs \$181) and 5x on ARPU (\$49 vs \$9).

## Surprises

- Growth is uncorrelated with size ( $\rho$  0.07) AND with asking price ( $r$  -0.01) — the market prices revenue, not momentum.
- 34% of startups are shrinking and 31% are exactly flat; only 66 (6.6%) grew >100% in 30 days.

## Largest opportunity

- 110 startups run >\$3k MRR with almost no audience or SEO — acquirable cash flow invisible to the market.
- Underpriced listings exist at <1x TTM revenue while the median ask is 4.8x.

## Key risks

- Revenue quality: 12% of trading firms are one-time-revenue heavy and 34% are in decline; MRR growth is the least reliable field (11% missing).
- Concentration: a single company (Stan) is 23% of all-time revenue — remove it and the market halves.

**Investor takeaway: this is an acquisition market, not a venture market — buy proven small cash flows at 1–3x revenue and consolidate distribution.**

# The universe on one screen

|                                                         |                                                   |                                                                  |                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>\$334.0m</div> <div>Total revenue (all-time)</div> | <div>\$334k</div> <div>Average revenue</div>      | <div>\$3,620</div> <div>Median revenue</div>                     | <div>\$13.5m</div> <div>Total MRR</div>                  |
| <div>\$13k</div> <div>Average MRR</div>                 | <div>\$282</div> <div>Median MRR</div>            | <div>0.0%</div> <div>Median growth 30D</div>                     | <div>17.4%</div> <div>Mean growth 30D (winsorised)</div> |
| <div>Stripe (64%)</div> <div>Most-used provider</div>   | <div>262 (26%)</div> <div>Startups for sale</div> | <div>\$332k</div> <div>Average asking price (median \$35k)</div> | <div>4.8x</div> <div>Median revenue multiple</div>       |

**SO WHAT** Mean-to-median ratios of 92x (revenue) and 48x (MRR) mean every 'average' in this market is a fiction — underwrite on medians and cohort percentiles, never averages.

Cohort benchmarks · P25 MRR \$10 · median \$282 · P75 \$5,040 · P90 \$23,369 · P99 \$177,206 · 212 startups above \$10k MRR, 16 above \$100k

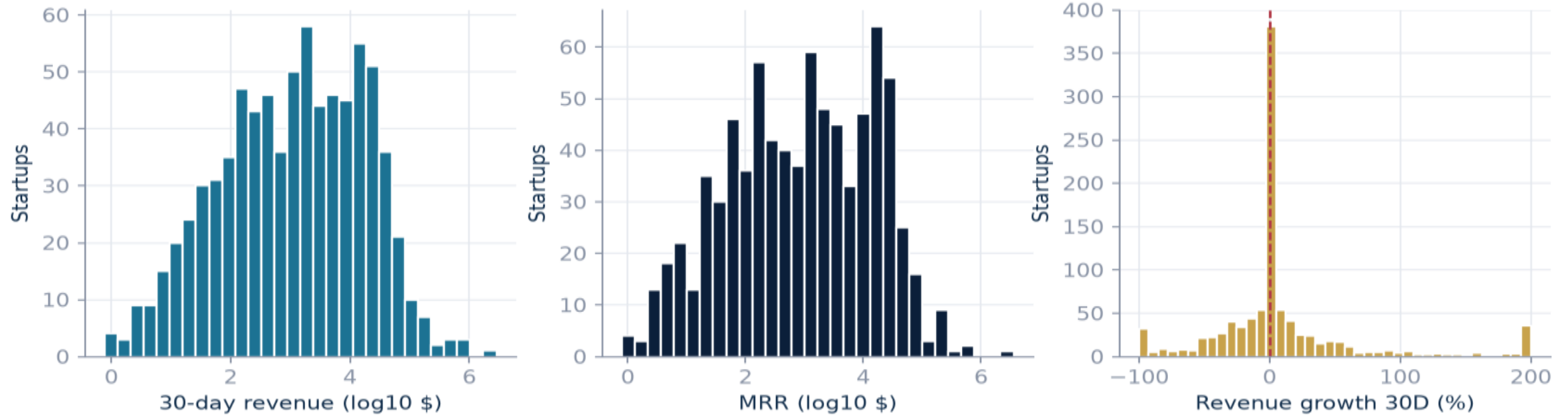
# 03

## **Business performance**

---

Revenue, traction quality, growth and the monetisation engine

# Log-normal revenue, spiked-at-zero growth: two different businesses in one file

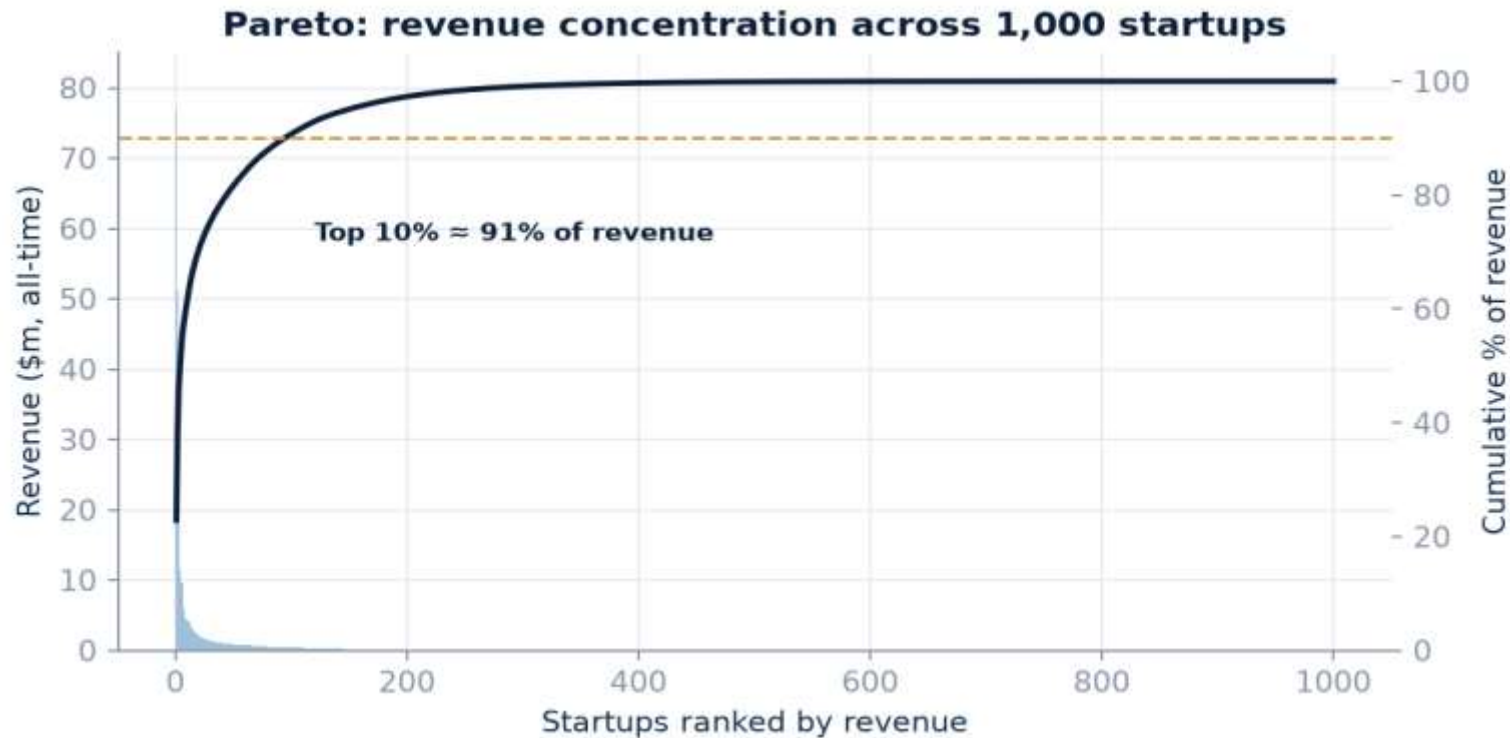


- Revenue and MRR are log-normal across five orders of magnitude — the modal live startup earns hundreds of dollars a month, not thousands.
- Growth is a spike at exactly 0% (305 firms) with fat tails both ways: 337 shrinking, 66 above +100%. Flat is the single most common outcome.
- 22% of the universe booked zero revenue in the last 30 days — a dead-weight tail that distorts any mean-based benchmark.

**SO WHAT** Benchmark candidates against the P75 (\$5.5k 30-day revenue) not the mean (\$15.6k): the mean is one company away from being wrong.



# 91% of all revenue sits in 100 companies — deal sourcing is a top-decile problem

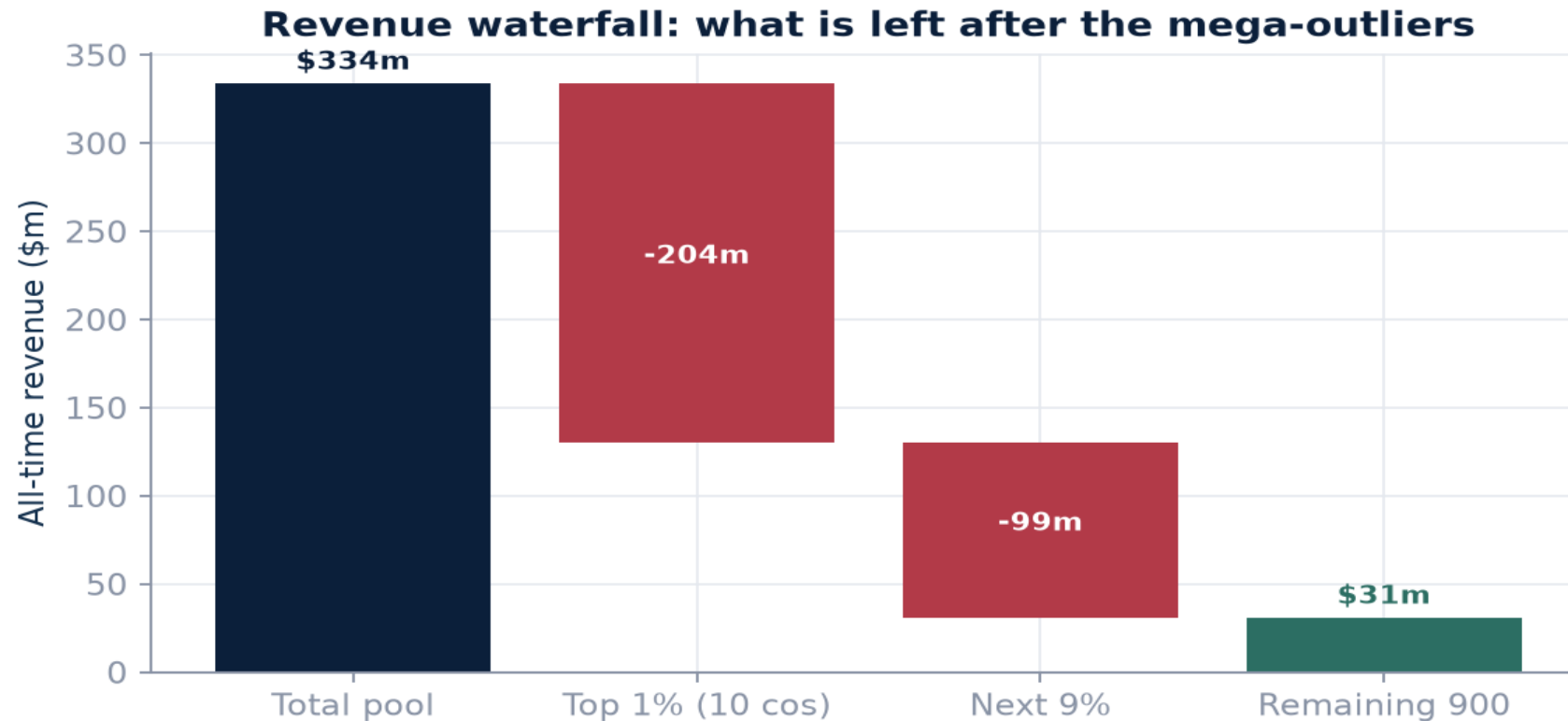


| Cohort              | Share of all-time revenue |
|---------------------|---------------------------|
| Top 1% (10 firms)   | 61%                       |
| Top 10% (100 firms) | 91%                       |
| Top 20%             | 97%                       |
| Bottom 50%          | 0%                        |
| Bottom 10%          | 0.0%                      |
| MRR in top 10%      | 82%                       |

- Largest single asset, Stan, is 23% of the dataset's lifetime revenue.
- Bottom 500 startups combined generated \$330k — less than one mid-tier listing's asking price.

**SO WHAT** Screening effort should be spent almost entirely on the top two deciles; a random sample of this market is a sample of zero-revenue projects.

## Strip the ten mega-outliers and the addressable pool falls to \$31m



- The ten largest companies (>\$4m lifetime each) are not realistically acquirable at micro-PE prices.
- The economically reachable universe for a sub-\$1m cheque is ~\$31m of lifetime revenue spread over 900 firms — thin, but full of \$10–50k assets.

**SO WHAT** Size the fund to the reachable pool, not the headline pool: a roll-up strategy here buys dozens of \$2–20k MRR assets, not a handful of trophies.

## Two thirds of trading revenue is genuinely recurring — PMF is real for the top quartile

**\$400**

Median 30-day revenue

**\$5,513 / \$24,588**

P75 / P90

**62%**

Recurring-heavy (MRR ≥80% of 30D rev)

**12%**

One-time heavy (<30%)

**66%**

Run-rate > trailing 12M (accelerating)

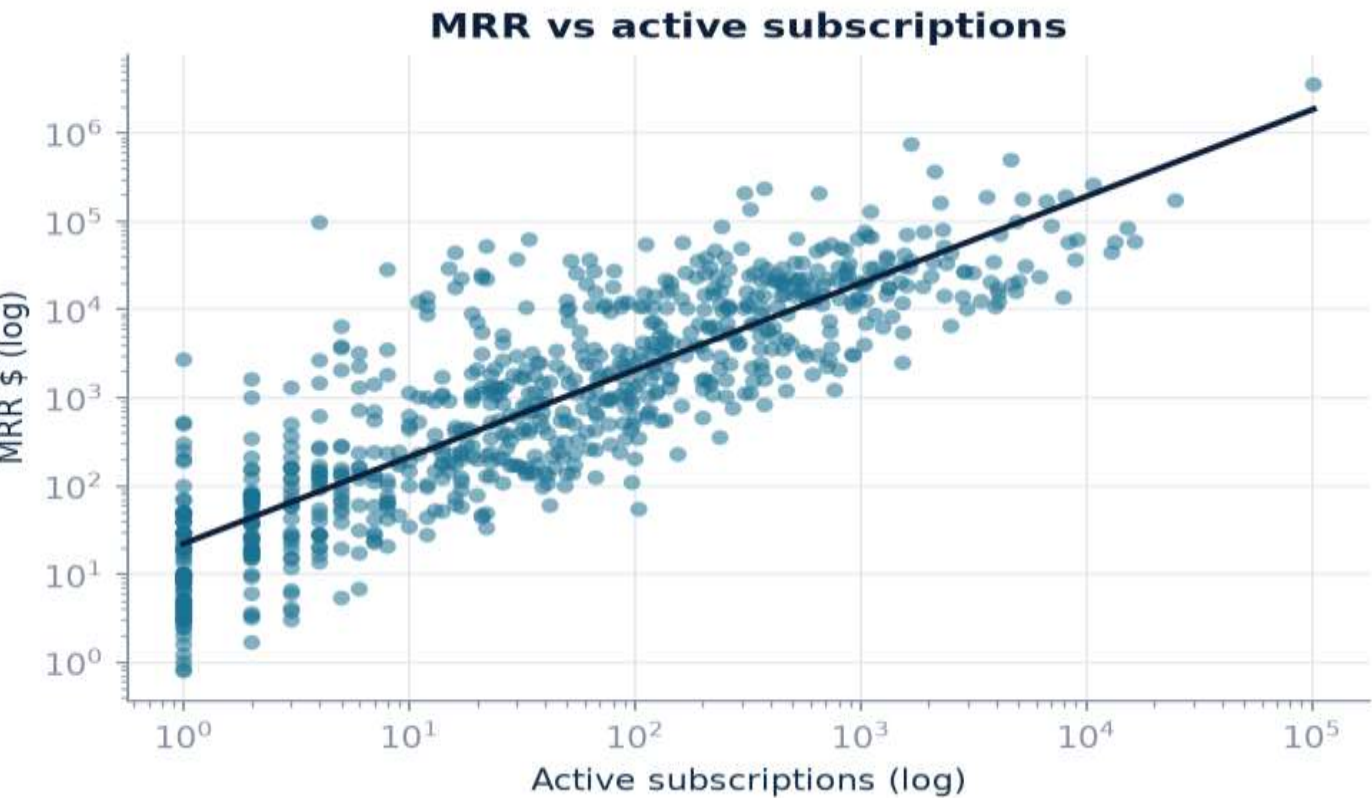
**216 (21.6%)**

Zero-revenue startups

- Traction: median run-rate (30-day revenue × 12) is 1.36x trailing-12M revenue — the typical trading company is genuinely growing into its history, not decaying.
- Sustainability: 62% of trading firms are recurring-heavy; 12% depend on one-off sales and should be discounted materially on any multiple.
- PMF marker used: >\$1k 30-day revenue AND ≥80% recurring AND non-negative growth — only 218 of 1,000 startups clear all three.

**SO WHAT** Revenue quality, not revenue level, is the cheapest edge in this dataset — the multiple paid for a recurring dollar should be double that of a one-time dollar.

MRR is a subscription-count game — ARPU is remarkably tight around \$20–50

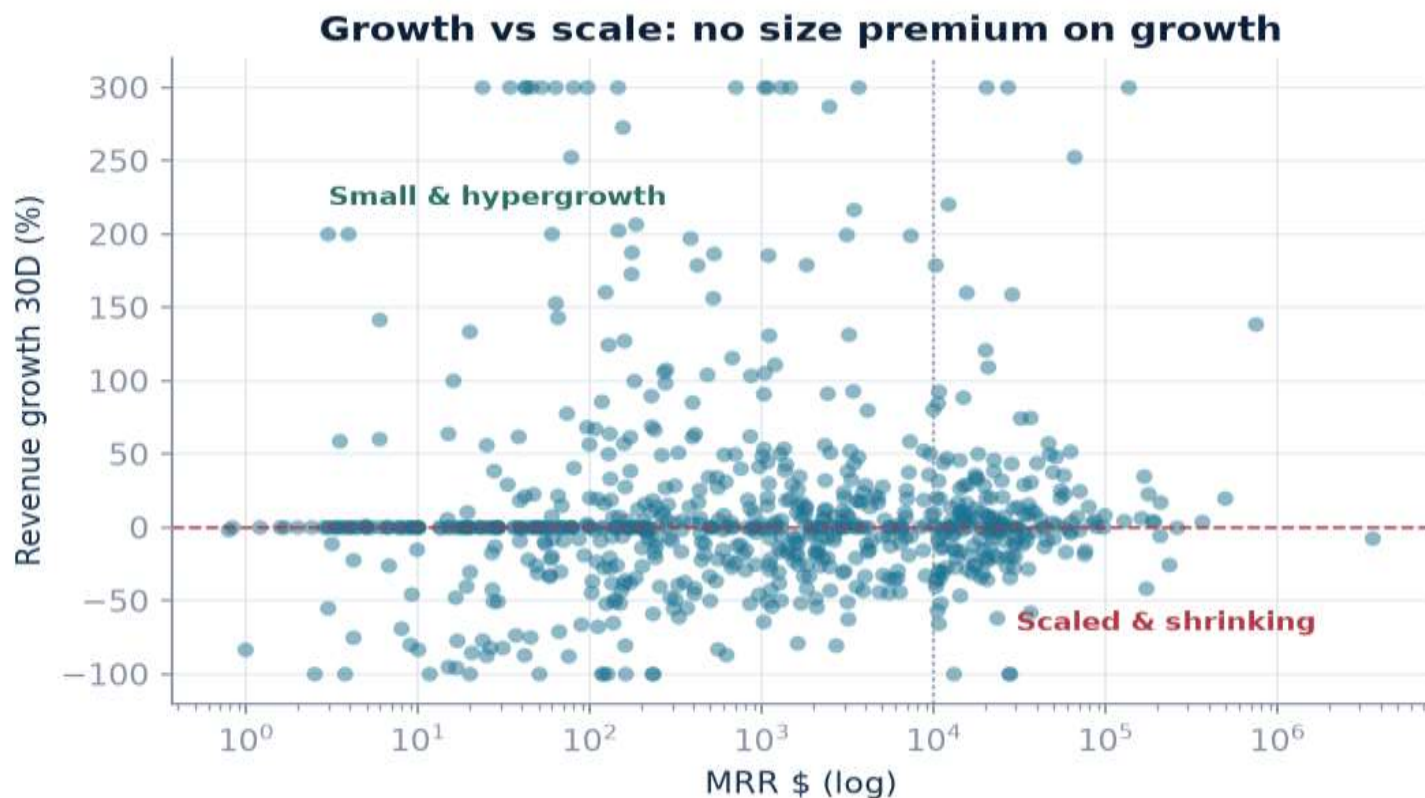


| Metric               | Value   |
|----------------------|---------|
| Total MRR            | \$13.5m |
| Median MRR           | \$282   |
| P90 MRR              | \$23k   |
| Median subscriptions | 16      |
| P90 subscriptions    | 769     |
| Median ARPU          | \$19.50 |
| B2B ARPU (median)    | \$49.00 |
| B2C ARPU (median)    | \$9.34  |

- $\rho(\text{MRR, subs}) = 0.90$  — the strongest relationship in the entire dataset.
- Highest-ARPU operators (Cometly \$676, Kibu \$625, VirtualJK \$487) are all B2B with <400 customers.

**SO WHAT** Diligence should test customer count and churn, not headline MRR: at fixed ARPU, MRR is simply a proxy for how many logos the founder can close.

# Scale buys no growth — and a third of the market is already shrinking



- Hypergrowth (>100% 30D): 66 firms (6.6%)
- Declining: 337 firms (33.7%)
- Exactly flat: 305 firms (30.5%)
- Above \$10k MRR: 212 firms
- Above \$100k MRR: 16 firms
- $\rho(\text{MRR}, \text{revenue growth}) = 0.07$  — statistically no size premium
- Median MRR growth: 0.0%; mean +33% is outlier-driven

**SO WHAT** Growth is idiosyncratic, so it cannot be bought by buying scale: pay for growth only where it is verified in the last 30 days, and pay nothing for it in a flat asset.

# Three portfolios hide inside one dataset

## Hypergrowth with real MRR (>\$1k)

| Company         | MRR       | Growth |
|-----------------|-----------|--------|
| HotelHero.ai    | \$1,460   | 1245%  |
| Stealth Company | \$135,899 | 719%   |
| Hong Xuan Kow   | \$20,254  | 598%   |
| Backlinker AI   | \$26,950  | 577%   |
| BillionVerify   | \$1,292   | 548%   |
| Hidden Jobs     | \$1,076   | 427%   |

## High MRR / negative growth — value traps or turnarounds

| Company               | MRR       | Growth |
|-----------------------|-----------|--------|
| Stealth Company       | \$747,069 | -74.3% |
| Rezi                  | \$259,701 | -4.9%  |
| 1Lookup               | \$207,064 | -7.5%  |
| Brand On Demand, I... | \$187,459 | -1.8%  |
| Stealth Company       | \$172,201 | 0.0%   |
| PROSP                 | \$128,005 | n/a%   |

## Low MRR / high growth — option value

| Company               | MRR   | Growth |
|-----------------------|-------|--------|
| Stealth Company       | \$54  | 1708%  |
| The Prettiest Girl    | \$168 | 1209%  |
| SHIPDOCS.sh           | \$36  | 403%   |
| VibeCom               | \$50  | 401%   |
| philosopherinvesto... | \$145 | 393%   |
| moadly                | \$7   | 224%   |

- 'Stealth Company' entries are anonymised listings and are reported as-is; they cluster in the high-MRR cohort, which suggests larger sellers hide their identity.
- Value traps matter: four of the ten largest MRR assets are contracting month-over-month, including two of the biggest AI names.

**SO WHAT** Build the portfolio from column three (cheap optionality) and column one (verified momentum); underwrite column two only with an operator who can fix churn.

# The leaderboard is US-based, Stripe-powered and B2B

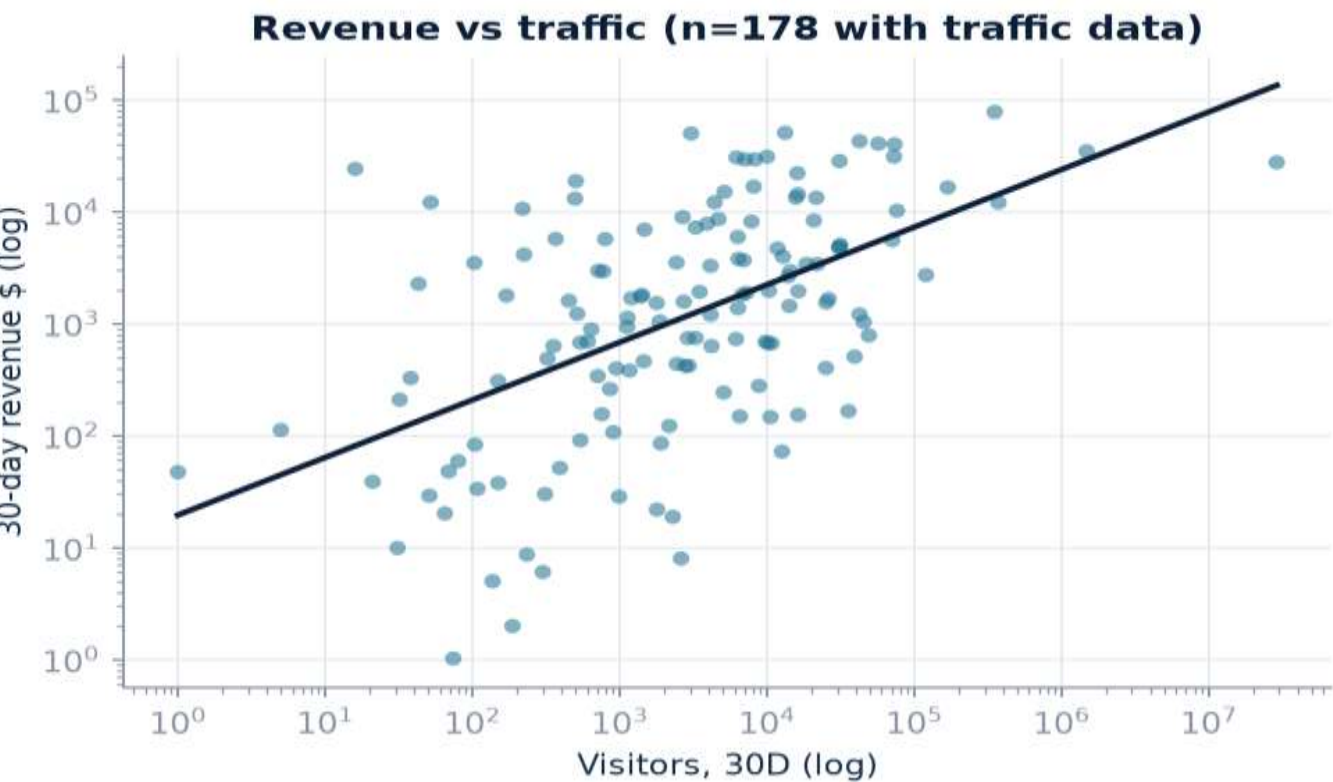
| Rank | Top 10 by all-time revenue | Category      | Country | Revenue |
|------|----------------------------|---------------|---------|---------|
| 1    | Stan                       | Uncategorised | US      | \$76.6m |
| 2    | Brand On Demand, Inc.      | E-comm        | US      | \$51.2m |
| 3    | Stack Influence            | Marketing     | US      | \$26.3m |
| 4    | Stealth Company            | Uncategorised | Unknown | \$11.3m |
| 5    | Rezi                       | AI            | US      | \$9.7m  |
| 6    | Cometly                    | Analytics     | US      | \$9.4m  |
| 7    | Stealth Company            | Uncategorised | GB      | \$5.9m  |
| 8    | Stealth Company            | Uncategorised | US      | \$4.8m  |
| 9    | DataExpert / TechCreator   | Education     | US      | \$4.5m  |
| 10   | Hidden Business            | Uncategorised | Unknown | \$4.4m  |

| Rank | Top 10 by MRR         | Category      | Country | MRR    |
|------|-----------------------|---------------|---------|--------|
| 1    | Stan                  | Uncategorised | US      | \$3.6m |
| 2    | Stealth Company       | Uncategorised | Unknown | \$747k |
| 3    | GojiberryAI           | AI            | US      | \$495k |
| 4    | Stealth Company       | Uncategorised | Unknown | \$364k |
| 5    | Rezi                  | AI            | US      | \$260k |
| 6    | Kibu                  | Education     | US      | \$234k |
| 7    | Cometly               | Analytics     | US      | \$208k |
| 8    | 1Lookup               | SaaS          | US      | \$207k |
| 9    | Stealth Company       | Uncategorised | FR      | \$191k |
| 10   | Brand On Demand, Inc. | E-comm        | US      | \$187k |

- Bottom decile: 100 startups with \$0 lifetime revenue — mostly launched-and-abandoned AI wrappers with no subscriptions and no traffic.
- 10 of 10 revenue leaders and 10 of 10 MRR leaders use Stripe as primary provider; 8 of 10 are US-domiciled.
- Only one consumer-app business appears in either leaderboard — this is a B2B revenue market.

**SO WHAT** If you want scale in this universe you are buying US B2B software on Stripe; anything else is a small-cheque, high-variance bet.

# Traffic explains revenue where it is reported — but most winners never disclose it



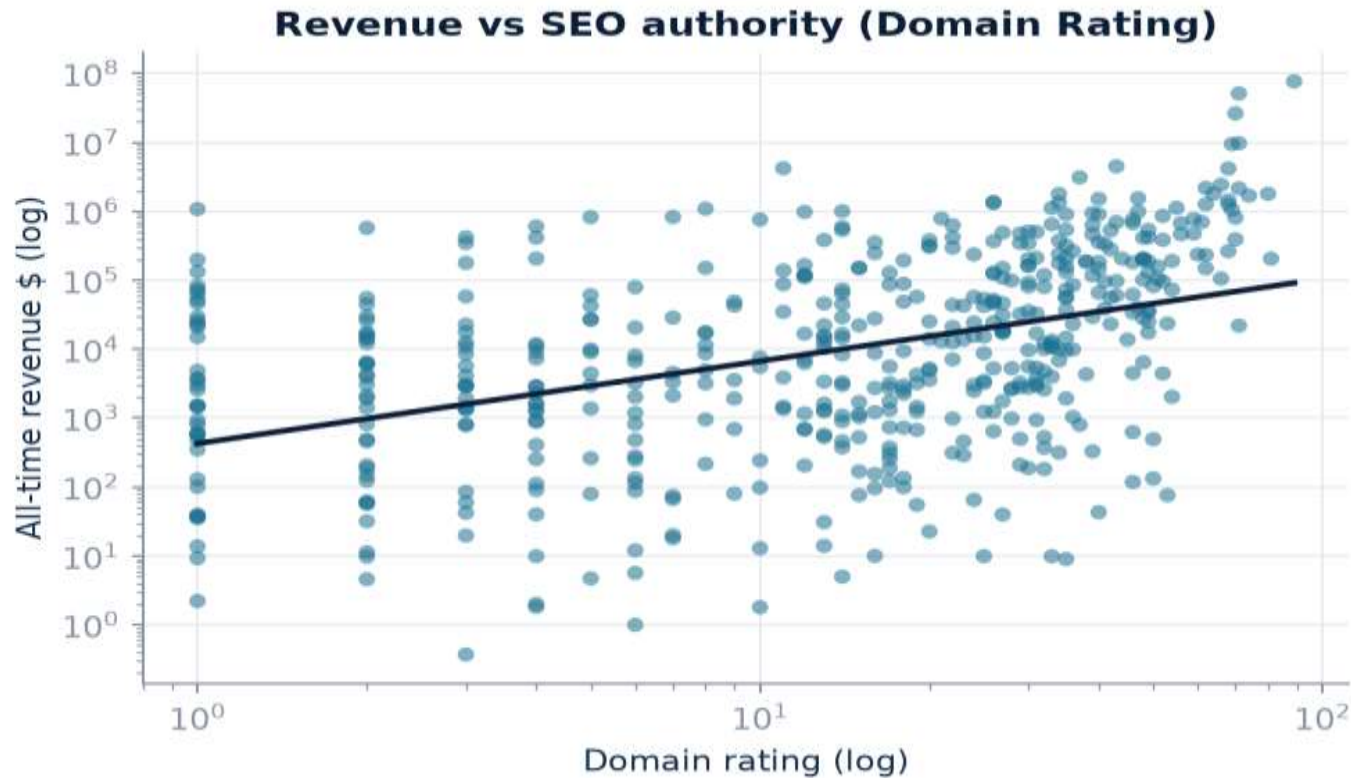
| Revenue per visitor | Value             |
|---------------------|-------------------|
| Median              | \$0.26            |
| P75                 | \$1.27            |
| P90                 | \$4.81            |
| Max                 | \$1,502.63        |
| Coverage            | 178 firms (17.8%) |

- Best monetisers per visit: Laper (\$1,503), ADELANTE (\$232), Avium (\$48), Khosmos (\$37) — all sales-assisted or high-ticket AI.
- Poor monetisers: large consumer apps with >100k visits and <\$0.05 per visitor — traffic without a paywall.
- $\rho(\text{visitors, 30-day revenue}) = 0.60$  on the reporting subset.

**SO WHAT** Revenue per visitor is the single best quick-screen for pricing power — anything above \$1 signals a business that does not need scale to be profitable.



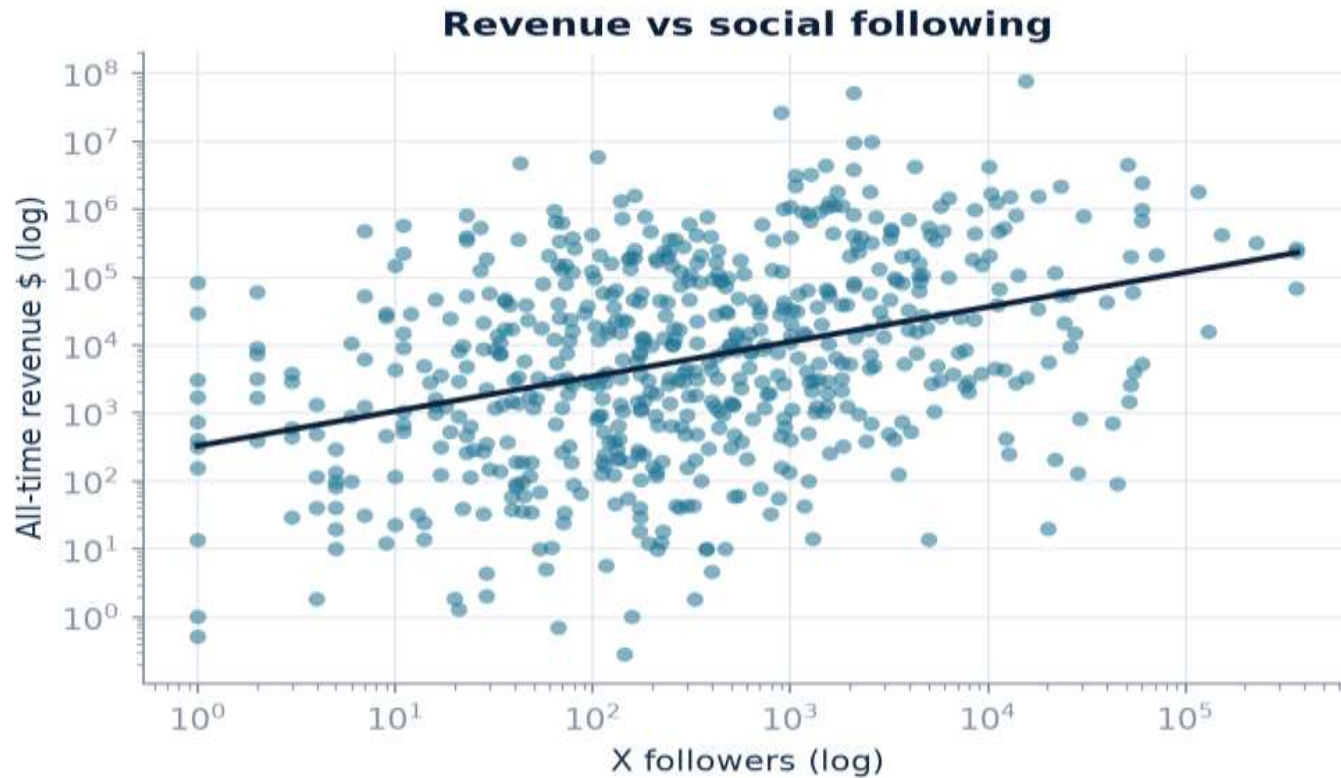
# Domain rating is a lagging badge of scale, not a growth engine



- Median domain rating is 10 and P25 is 1: three quarters of this market has effectively no search authority.
- $\rho(\text{DR, all-time revenue}) = 0.57$ , but  $\rho(\text{DR, growth}) \approx 0.01$  — authority correlates with age and size, not momentum.
- 110 startups clear \$3k MRR with  $\text{DR} < 20$  and  $< 200$  followers — revenue without any discoverable footprint.
- Coverage caveat: DR is present for 71% of firms; the missing 29% skew tiny.

**SO WHAT** SEO is an underwriting opportunity, not a filter: acquiring a \$5k-MRR asset with  $\text{DR} < 10$  leaves the entire organic channel as unexploited upside.

# An audience is neither necessary nor sufficient for revenue



- $\rho(X \text{ followers, revenue}) = 0.23$  — the weakest of the scale metrics.
- 44% of startups have zero followers; median is 67.
- The 36 accounts above 20k followers do earn more (median MRR \$1,695 vs \$268) — a 6x gap, but on a tiny base.
- Largest audiences monetise inconsistently: several 100k+ follower accounts sit below \$500 MRR.

**SO WHAT** Do not pay a premium for founder audience: it is a distribution accelerant for a good product, never a substitute for one — and it does not transfer in an acquisition.

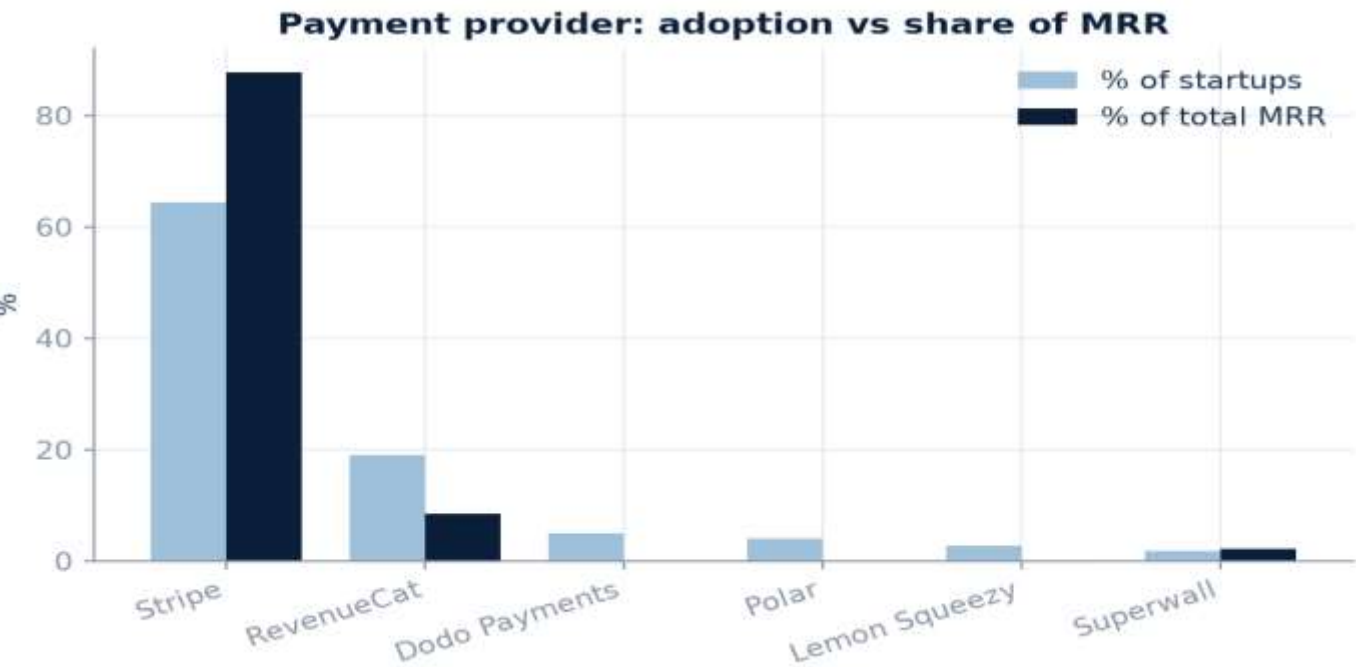
# 04

## Segment economics

---

Providers, categories, pricing, personas and geography

# Stripe is the market — and it is where the money is, not just the logos

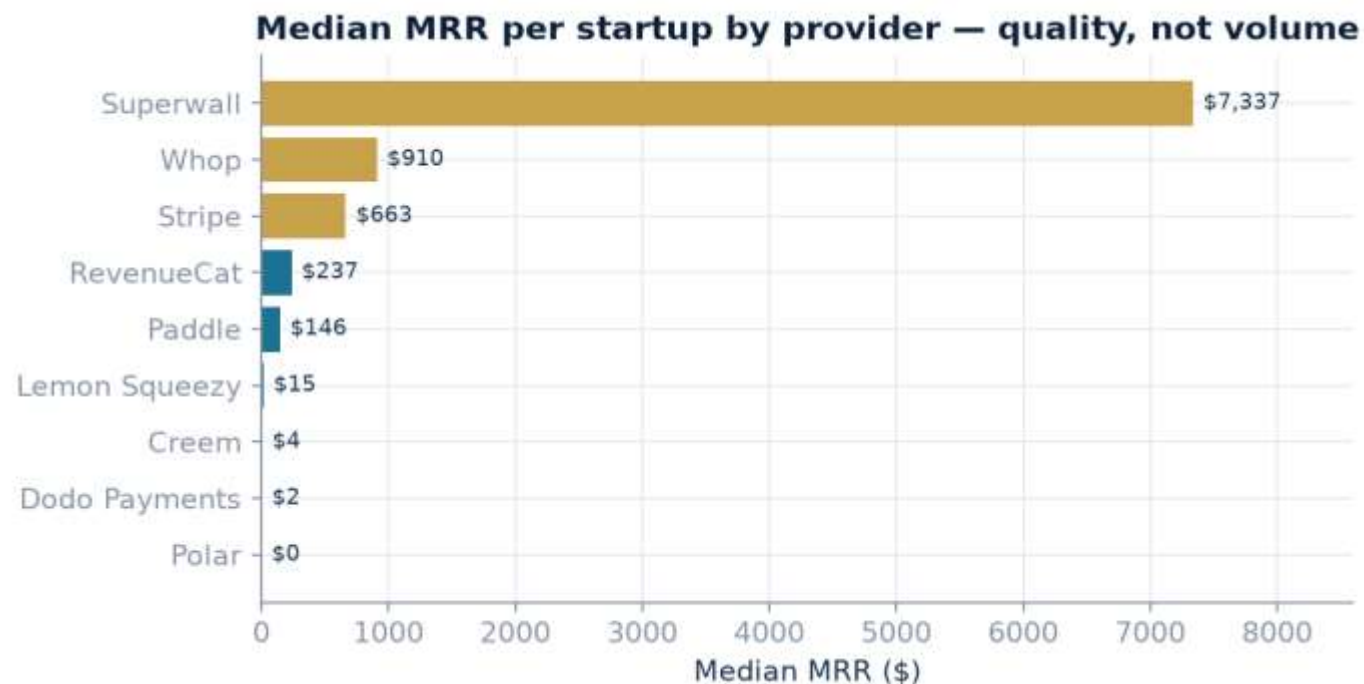


| Provider      | Firms | % of MRR | Median MRR |
|---------------|-------|----------|------------|
| Stripe        | 644   | 88%      | \$663      |
| RevenueCat    | 191   | 9%       | \$237      |
| Dodo Payments | 50    | 0%       | \$2        |
| Polar         | 40    | 0%       | \$0        |
| Lemon Squeezy | 27    | 0%       | \$15       |
| Superwall     | 19    | 2%       | \$7,337    |
| Paddle        | 16    | 1%       | \$146      |

- Stripe: 64% of startups but 88% of MRR and 95% of lifetime revenue.
- Among high-growth firms (>50% 30D), Stripe's share rises to 73%; RevenueCat is 17%.
- 13 startups run multi-provider stacks — a maturity signal (median MRR well above cohort).

**SO WHAT** Provider choice is a proxy for business model: a Stripe key implies web B2B billing, a RevenueCat key implies app-store consumer economics with structurally lower ARPU.

## Niche providers signal niche economics — with two exceptions worth screening

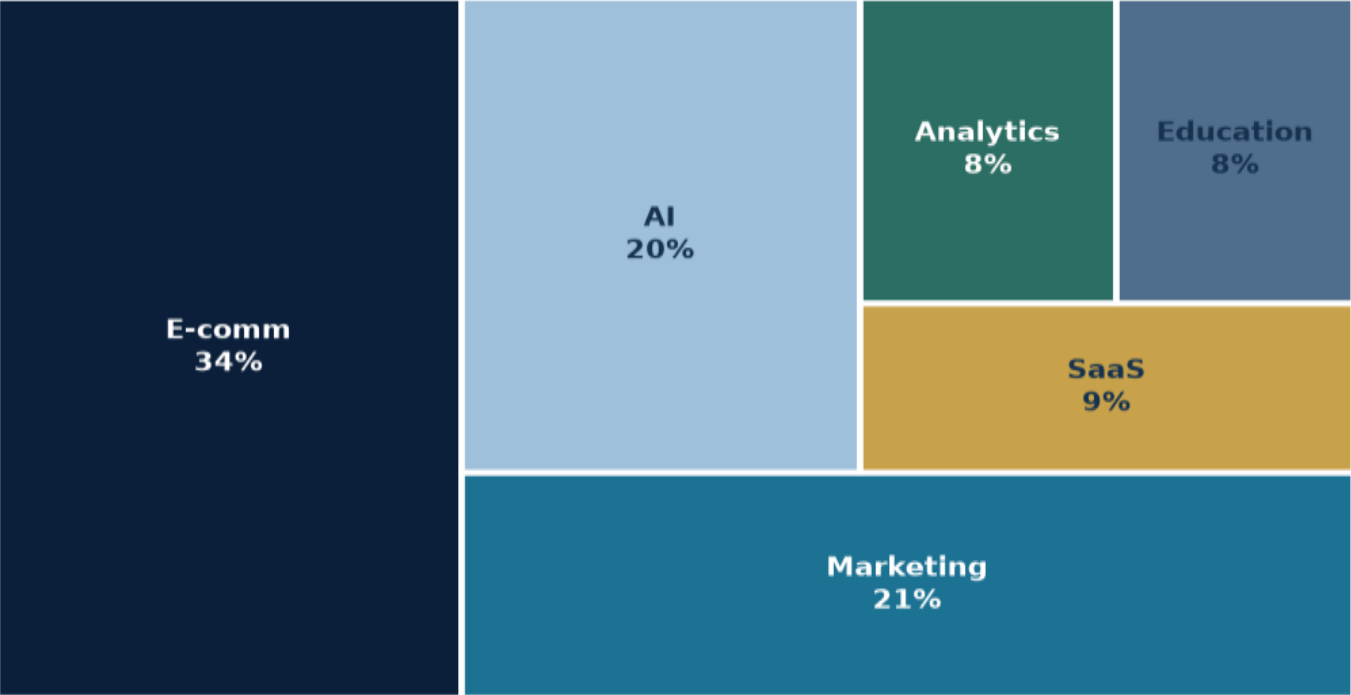


- Superwall (19 firms, median MRR \$7,337) and Whop (\$910) index to serious paywall-optimised operators — a high-yield screening list despite tiny n.
- Dodo Payments, Polar and Lemon Squeezy skew to pre-revenue builders: median MRR under \$20 across 117 firms.
- RevenueCat's 191 mobile apps hold 8.5% of MRR at \$237 median — volume without pricing power (ARPU \$3.42 in mobile IAP).
- Superwall and Creem cohorts show negative median growth — high revenue but contracting; diligence churn hard.

**SO WHAT** Use the provider field as a free pre-qualification layer: Stripe + Superwall + Whop covers 67% of firms and virtually all of the acquirable cash flow.

# Revenue is concentrated in commerce and marketing; AI is crowded but pays

Share of all-time revenue by category (top 6 of 28)

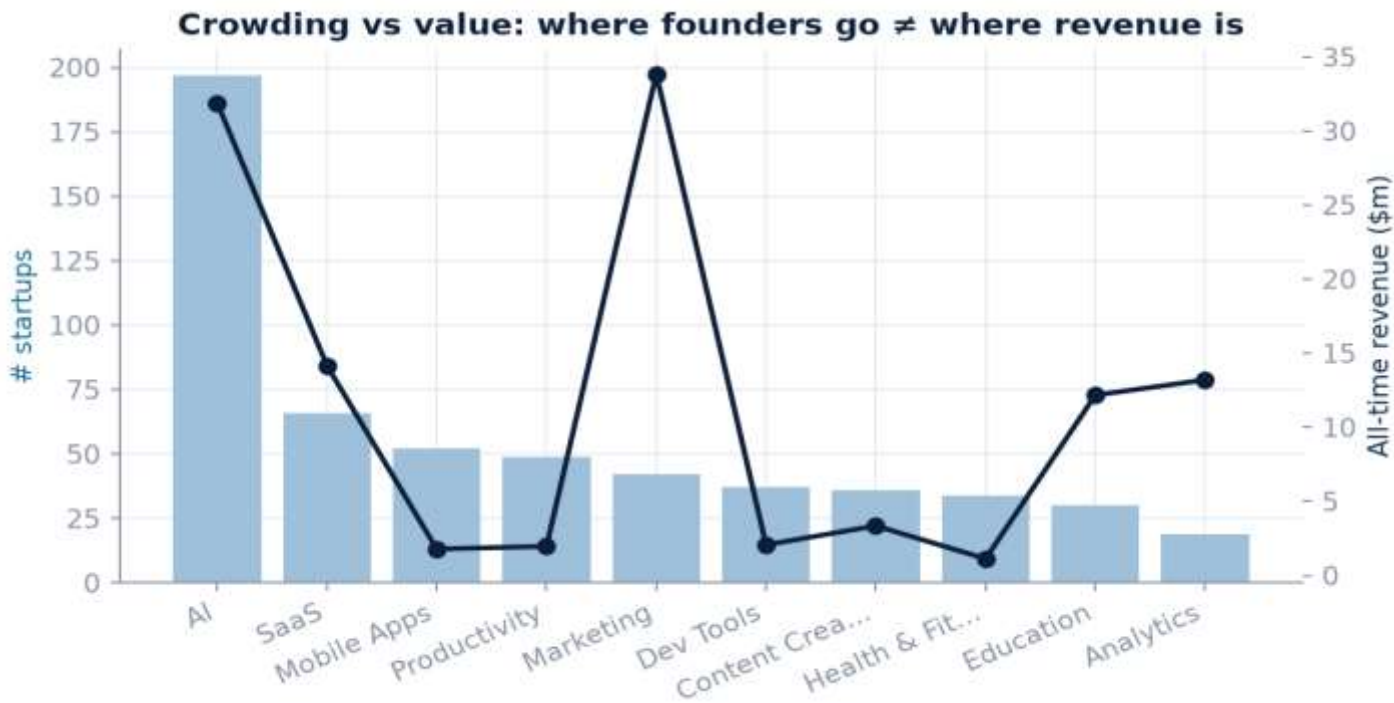


| Category         | n   | Revenue | Median MRR |
|------------------|-----|---------|------------|
| E-comm           | 19  | \$54.8m | \$155      |
| Marketing        | 42  | \$33.8m | \$1,586    |
| AI               | 197 | \$31.9m | \$446      |
| SaaS             | 66  | \$14.2m | \$303      |
| Analytics        | 19  | \$13.2m | \$1,294    |
| Education        | 30  | \$12.2m | \$2,142    |
| Social Media     | 18  | \$3.4m  | \$912      |
| Content Creation | 36  | \$3.4m  | \$1,254    |

- E-comm: 19 firms, \$55m — driven by two outliers; median MRR only \$155.
- Marketing and Analytics combine high totals with high medians: the healthiest categories.

**SO WHAT** Totals are outlier artefacts — rank categories on median MRR (Education \$2,142, Marketing \$1,586, Analytics \$1,294) when choosing where to hunt.

# Founders pile into AI; the money sits in Marketing, Analytics and Education

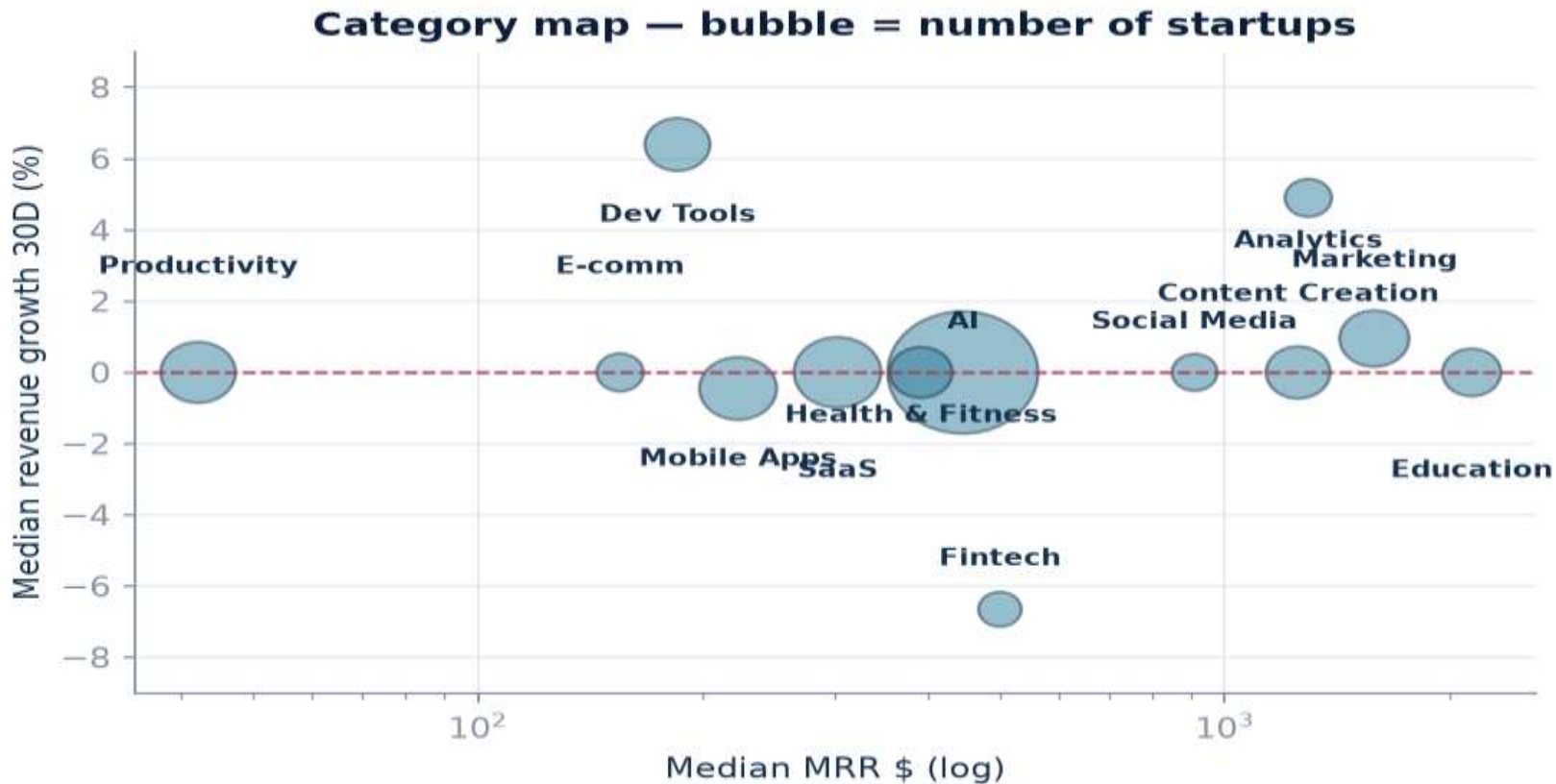


| Highest median MRR | Median MRR | n   |
|--------------------|------------|-----|
| Education          | \$2,142    | 30  |
| Marketing          | \$1,586    | 42  |
| Analytics          | \$1,294    | 19  |
| Content Creation   | \$1,254    | 36  |
| Social Media       | \$912      | 18  |
| AI                 | \$446      | 197 |
| Productivity       | \$42       | 49  |

- AI is 20% of all startups but delivers a median MRR 79% below Education.
- Productivity is the worst risk-adjusted category: 49 firms, \$42 median MRR.

**SO WHAT** Category crowding is inversely related to monetisation — the contrarian screen (Education, Analytics, Marketing) offers 3–5x better median economics per deal reviewed.

# Only Dev Tools and Analytics combine positive momentum with real revenue

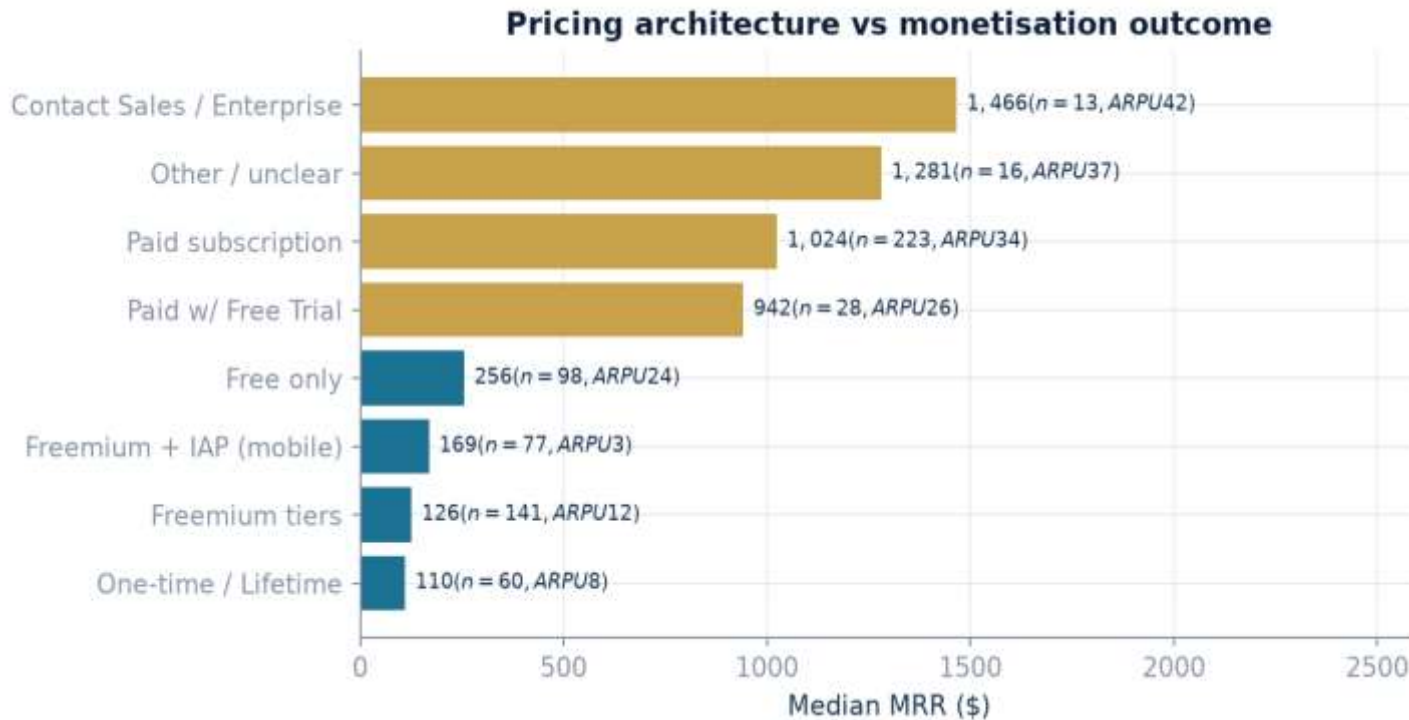


- Fastest median growth: Recruiting & HR (+61%, n=6), Dev Tools (+6.4%), Customer Support (+5.3%), Analytics (+4.9%).
- Fintech (-6.7%) and Sales (-12%) are contracting cohorts despite decent MRR — regulatory and competitive pressure.

**SO WHAT** Two-factor category screen — median MRR > \$500 AND median growth > 0 — reduces 28 categories to five and captures most of the attractive deal flow.



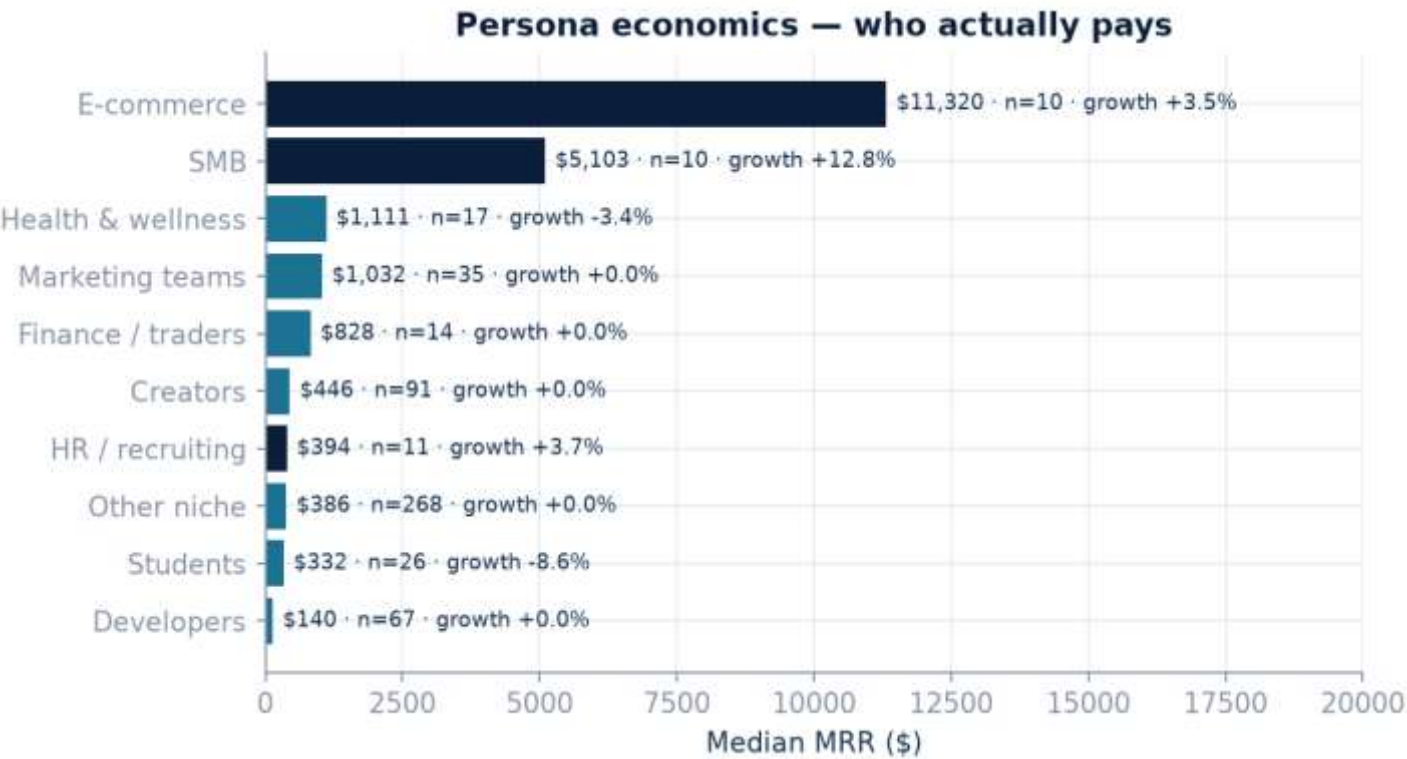
# Charging money beats freemium by 8x on median MRR



- Paid subscription (n=223): median MRR \$1,024, ARPU \$34 — the highest-performing mainstream strategy.
- Contact Sales / Enterprise: highest median MRR (\$1,466) and ARPU (\$42) but negative median growth and n=13 — pricing power without velocity.
- Freemium tiers (n=141): median MRR \$126 — 8x worse than pure paid, and the most common architecture after paid.
- Mobile IAP (n=77): most subscriptions (median 36) but ARPU of \$3.42 — volume masquerading as traction.

**SO WHAT** The single highest-ROI post-acquisition lever is removing the free tier: same product, same traffic, 3–8x the median revenue per customer.

# Sell to businesses that already have revenue — everything else pays in cents

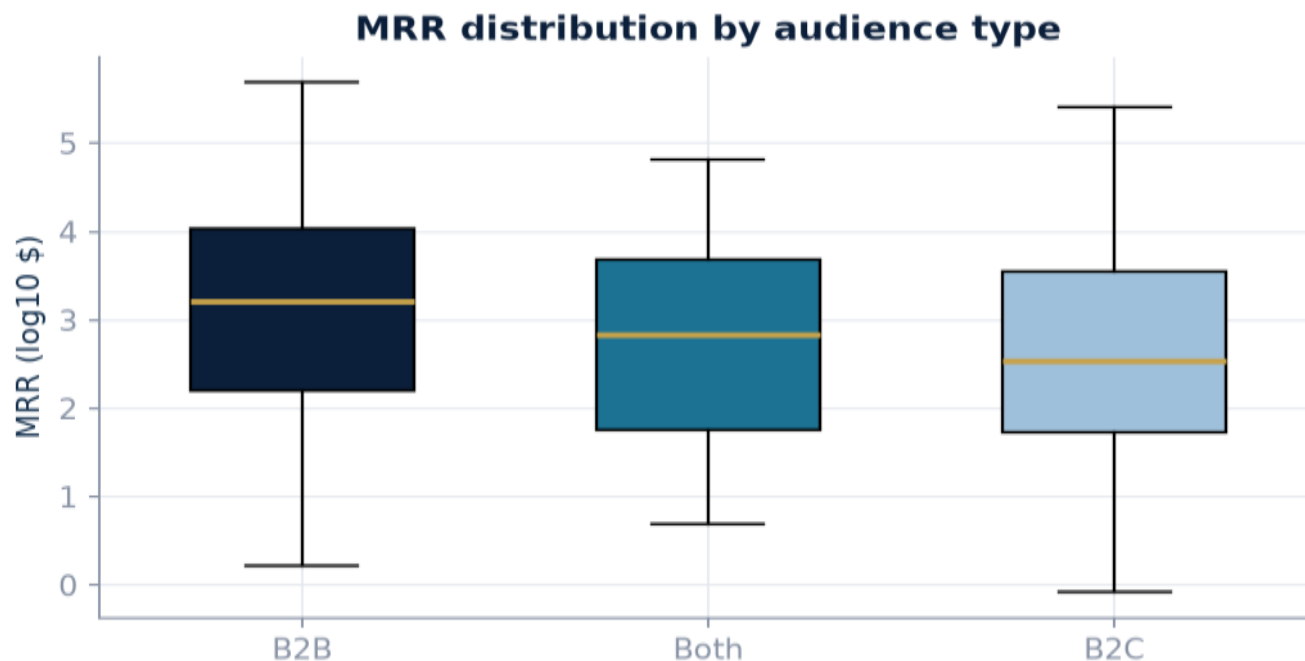


| Persona           | n   | Median MRR | Growth |
|-------------------|-----|------------|--------|
| E-commerce        | 10  | \$11,320   | 3.5%   |
| SMB               | 10  | \$5,103    | 12.8%  |
| Health & wellness | 17  | \$1,111    | -3.4%  |
| Marketing teams   | 35  | \$1,032    | 0.0%   |
| Finance / traders | 14  | \$828      | 0.0%   |
| Creators          | 91  | \$446      | 0.0%   |
| HR / recruiting   | 11  | \$394      | 3.7%   |
| Other niche       | 268 | \$386      | 0.0%   |

- E-commerce operators (\$11,320) and SMBs (\$5,103) pay 25–80x more than developers (\$140) and founders (\$77).
- Creators are the most crowded persona (91 firms) at a median \$446 MRR.

**SO WHAT** Persona choice is the biggest determinant of outcome in this dataset — a mediocre product sold to e-commerce operators out-earns an excellent product sold to indie founders.

# The B2B premium is structural: 5.7x MRR, 5.2x ARPU, 3.8x lifetime revenue

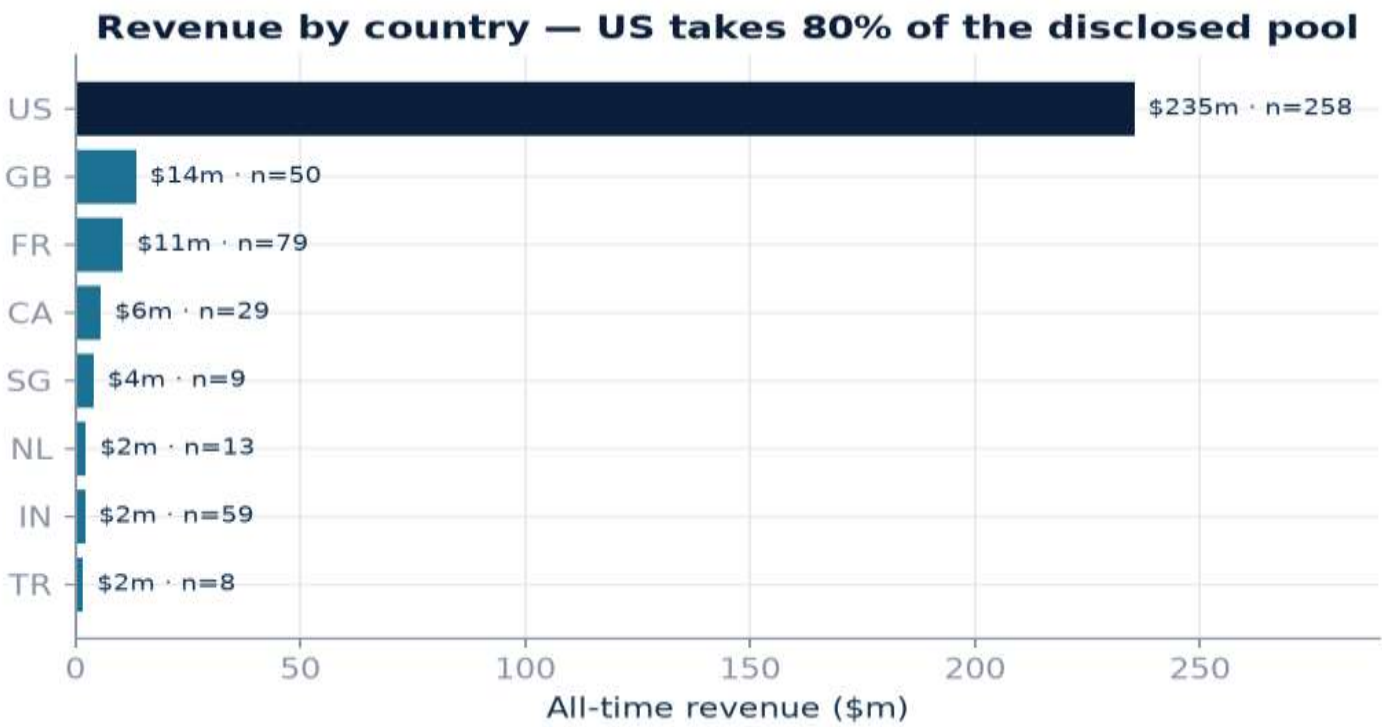


| Segment | n   | Median MRR | Median revenue | ARPU    |
|---------|-----|------------|----------------|---------|
| B2B     | 255 | \$1,036    | \$10,319       | \$49.00 |
| B2C     | 401 | \$181      | \$2,735        | \$9.34  |
| Both    | 56  | \$352      | \$4,235        | \$17.37 |

- B2C is the majority of firms (401) but a minority of value — the classic micro-SaaS trap.
- 'Both' sits exactly between the two: hybrid positioning dilutes pricing power rather than expanding the market.
- B2C wins only on subscription counts, never on revenue per subscription.

**SO WHAT** Any B2C asset should be underwritten at a materially lower multiple than an equivalent-MRR B2B asset — the same revenue is harder to hold and cheaper per customer.

# US firms are 26% of the count and 80% of the disclosed revenue



| Country | n   | Revenue  | Median MRR | Growth |
|---------|-----|----------|------------|--------|
| US      | 258 | \$235.4m | \$1,263    | 0.0%   |
| GB      | 50  | \$13.5m  | \$153      | 0.0%   |
| FR      | 79  | \$10.6m  | \$435      | 0.0%   |
| CA      | 29  | \$5.7m   | \$919      | -0.1%  |
| SG      | 9   | \$4.1m   | \$2,126    | 0.0%   |
| NL      | 13  | \$2.4m   | \$1,022    | -15.4% |
| IN      | 59  | \$2.2m   | \$6        | 0.0%   |

- Fastest growing (n≥8): Australia +9.5%, Spain +6.8%, Estonia +3.5%.
- India: 59 firms but median MRR of just \$6 — high volume, near-zero monetisation.
- Singapore punches highest per firm: \$2,126 median MRR on 9 companies.
- 24% of firms disclose no country — treat geographic totals as a lower bound.

**SO WHAT** Global sourcing, US pricing: the arbitrage is buying non-US-built products with US-quality economics (Estonia, Singapore, Australia) before they re-price.

# 05

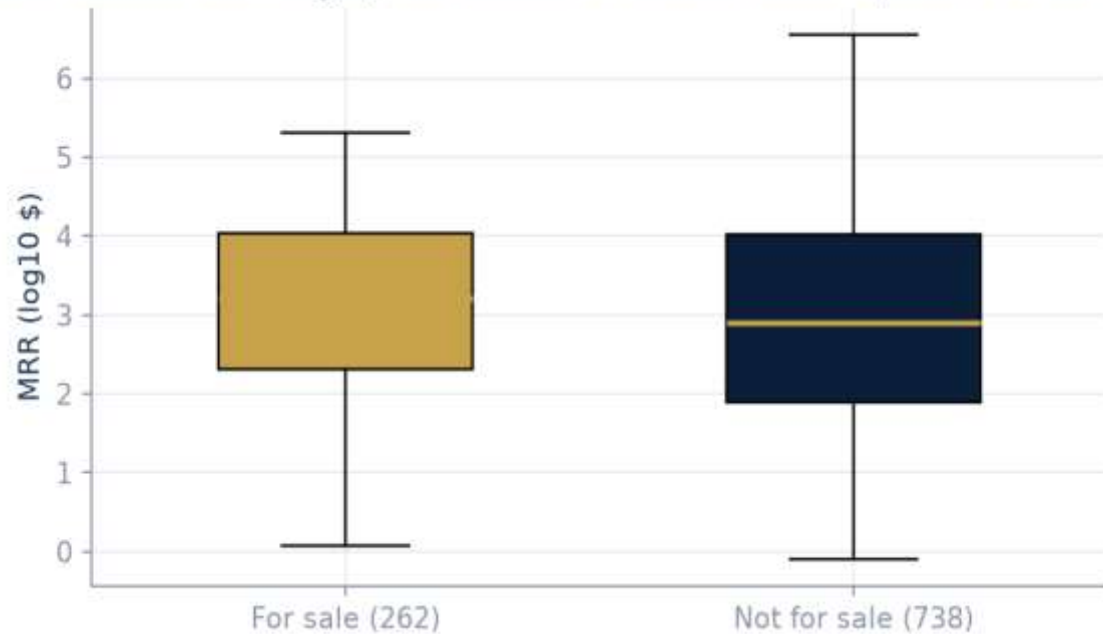
## The for-sale market

---

262 listed assets, what they ask and where the mispricing sits

# A quarter of the universe is for sale — and sellers are the bigger businesses

Listed assets are larger, not weaker: median MRR 1,055 USD vs 282 USD



**262 (26.2%)**

Listed for sale

**\$35k**

Median asking price

**\$332k**

Average asking price (median \$35k)

**4.8x**

Median implied multiple

**\$1,055 vs \$282**

Median MRR (listed vs rest)

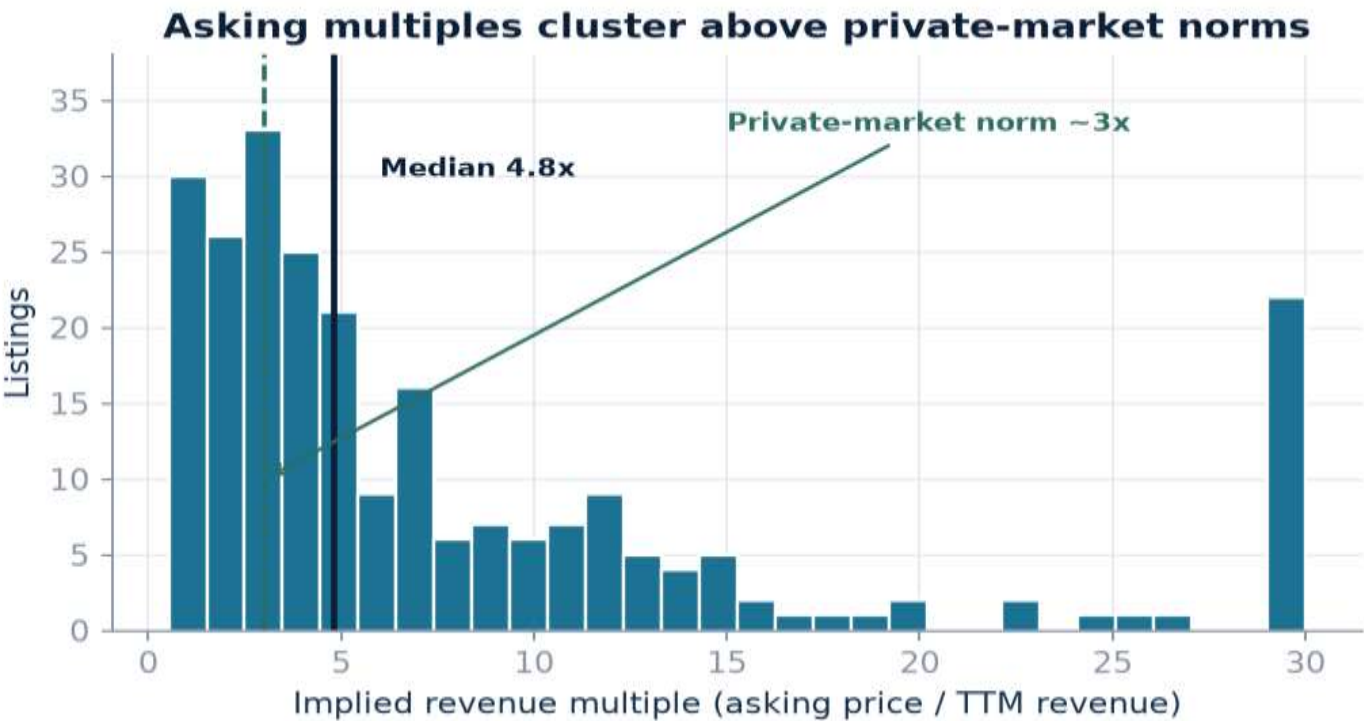
**\$86.8m**

Aggregate ask value

- Price dispersion is extreme: P25 \$5,000 vs P90 \$1,000,000 — a 200x range inside one marketplace.
- Listed assets grow no faster or slower than the rest (median 0% both ways): sellers are exiting size, not decline.

**SO WHAT** Supply is abundant and quality-skewed upward — a disciplined buyer can be extremely selective without leaving the dataset.

# The median ask is 4.8x revenue — roughly 60% above the private micro-SaaS norm



| Implied multiple (ask ÷ TTM revenue) | Value     |
|--------------------------------------|-----------|
| P25                                  | 2.5x      |
| Median                               | 4.8x      |
| P75                                  | 10.6x     |
| P90                                  | 23.8x     |
| Listings below 3x                    | 72 of 243 |
| Listings above 10x                   | 61 of 243 |

- Sellers' own stated multiples (median 2.3x) are systematically lower than the multiple implied by their asking price and trailing revenue — the marketing number is not the real number.
- 47 listings state a 0.0x multiple, mostly pre-revenue assets being sold as ideas.

**SO WHAT** Always recompute the multiple yourself: relying on the listed 'x' understates the true ask by roughly 2x across the marketplace.

# Price tracks revenue tightly at scale and completely breaks down below \$10k revenue

Asking price vs revenue: multiple discipline breaks down at the low end



- Correlation of  $\log(\text{price})$  with  $\log(\text{TTM revenue}) = 0.87$  — a real, functioning pricing mechanism at the top.
- Below \$10k trailing revenue the scatter is vertical: identical revenue attracts asks from \$2.5k to \$1.5m.
- Every point above the 10x line requires a narrative — not a spreadsheet — to justify.

**SO WHAT** The exploitable inefficiency is concentrated in sub-\$100k-revenue listings, where price is set by seller sentiment rather than by cash flow.



# Growth is not priced in — the market's biggest single blind spot



- Correlation between 30-day growth and implied multiple:  $-0.01$ .
- A company growing +100% and one shrinking -50% command statistically identical multiples.
- In venture and public markets, growth is the dominant multiple driver; here it is noise.

**SO WHAT** Buy growth for free: screen listings for >20% verified 30-day growth and pay the market's flat 3–5x — this alone is the most repeatable alpha in the dataset.

## Eight listings priced below 1x trailing revenue — with real MRR behind them

| Company           | Asking price | TTM revenue | MRR      | Multiple | 30D growth |
|-------------------|--------------|-------------|----------|----------|------------|
| BuildMyAgent.io   | \$289k       | \$542k      | \$20,494 | 0.53x    | 8.0%       |
| Videotok          | \$75k        | \$137k      | \$4,731  | 0.55x    | 20.3%      |
| Stealth Company   | \$160k       | \$278k      | \$19,240 | 0.57x    | -31.6%     |
| Supaflo           | \$3k         | \$4k        | \$96     | 0.58x    | 360.7%     |
| Linkedit          | \$5k         | \$8k        | \$1,036  | 0.61x    | 105.2%     |
| divinetalk        | \$14k        | \$20k       | \$2,054  | 0.70x    | -48.4%     |
| ColdSire          | \$215k       | \$303k      | \$18,887 | 0.71x    | -0.3%      |
| Kortex-Notebooklm | \$150k       | \$206k      | \$3,020  | 0.73x    | -29.7%     |

- BuildMyAgent.io: \$289k for \$542k trailing revenue and \$20.5k MRR while still growing — a 14-month payback at face value.
- Videotok and Linkedit combine sub-0.65x pricing with +20% and +105% growth respectively.
- Caveats: three of the eight are contracting sharply (-30% to -48%) and 'Stealth Company' listings hide the underlying brand — cheap for a reason until proven otherwise.

**SO WHAT** Two or three of these clear a 24-month cash payback even under conservative churn — this is where the first cheques should go, subject to code and churn diligence.

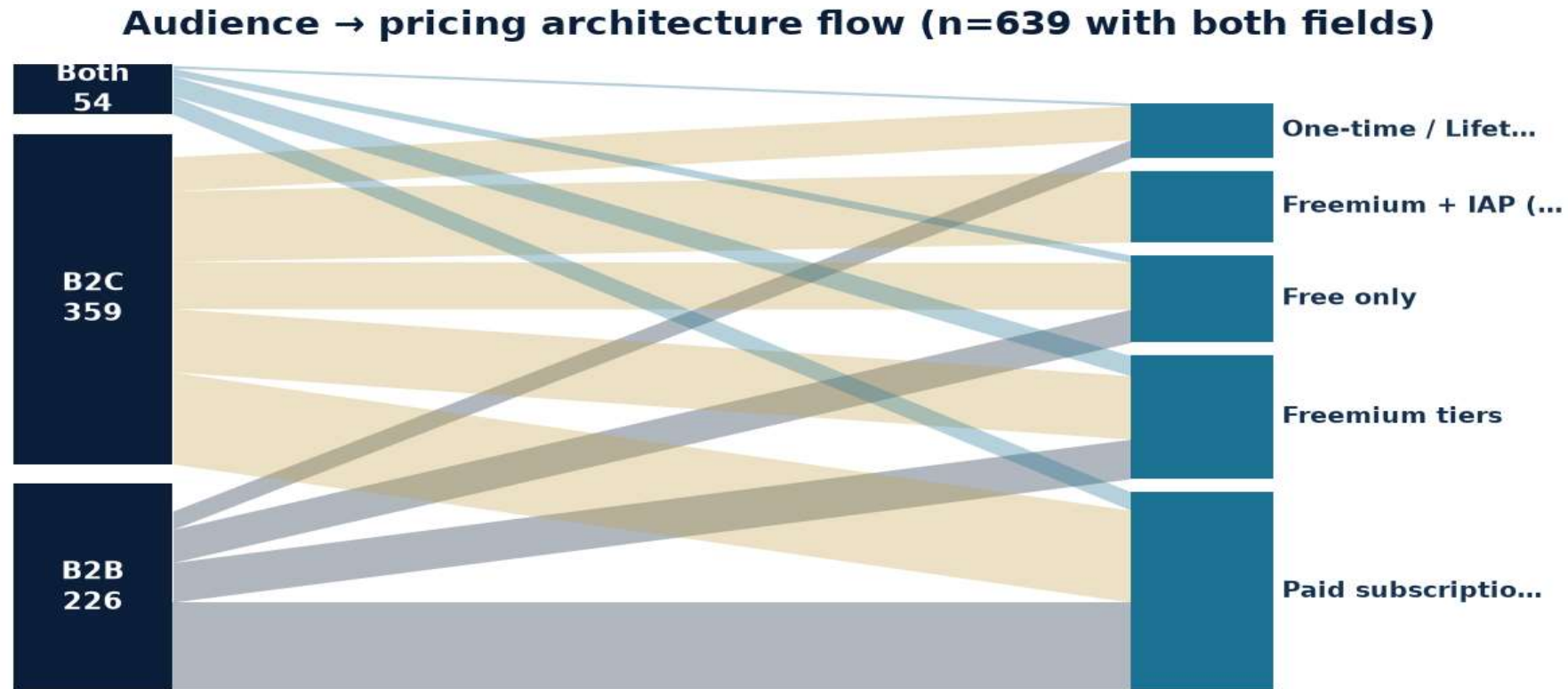
# The tail of the market is selling stories: multiples of 200x to 62,500x

| Company                            | Asking price | TTM revenue | MRR     | Implied multiple |
|------------------------------------|--------------|-------------|---------|------------------|
| Hypeflare                          | \$1.5m       | \$24.00     | \$0.00  | 62,500x          |
| SmarterCal                         | \$3k         | \$1.17      | \$0.00  | 2,137x           |
| DataSaaS                           | \$10k        | \$7.99      | \$7.99  | 1,252x           |
| VENTRIUM AI                        | \$10k        | \$12.90     | \$0.00  | 775x             |
| Orato AI: Speak clearly. Grow your | \$3k         | \$4.99      | \$0.00  | 501x             |
| Ringtones for iPhone 2019          | \$10k        | \$32.50     | \$25.63 | 308x             |
| MyBite                             | \$10k        | \$37.06     | \$1.20  | 270x             |
| Scrivibe   AI Book Generator       | \$49k        | \$261.00    | \$0.00  | 188x             |

- Hypeflare asks \$1.5m against \$24 of trailing revenue — a 62,500x multiple; this is an idea sale, not a business sale.
- Systematic pattern: near-zero revenue plus a \$2.5k–\$10k ask. 47 listings price at a stated 0.0x, i.e. pre-revenue.
- These listings inflate every marketplace-level average — the mean implied multiple (289x) is meaningless; the median (4.8x) is the market.

**SO WHAT** Filter the marketplace to listings with >\$1k MRR before forming any view on price levels; otherwise pre-revenue noise dominates the comparables set.

# How audience choice cascades into pricing architecture



- B2C founders overwhelmingly choose freemium and mobile IAP — the two lowest-ARPU architectures in the dataset.
- B2B founders default to paid subscription, which is also the highest-performing architecture: strategy and segment reinforce each other.

**SO WHAT** The B2C monetisation gap is a pricing-design problem as much as a market problem — and pricing design is fixable post-acquisition within one quarter.

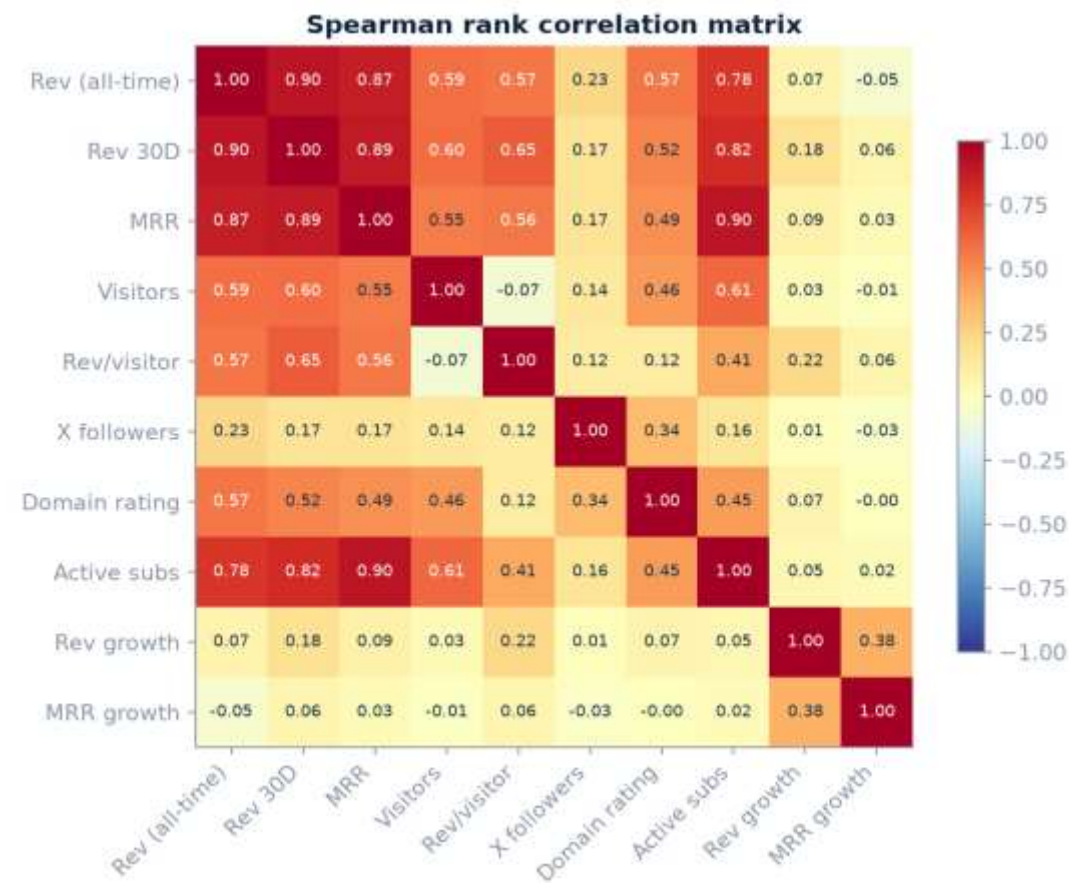
# 06

## Correlations & insights

---

What actually predicts revenue — and 25 investable observations

# Spearman rank correlations across the ten core metrics



| Strongest relationships      | ρ    |
|------------------------------|------|
| Rev (all-time) ↔ Rev 30D     | 0.90 |
| MRR ↔ Active subs            | 0.90 |
| Rev 30D ↔ MRR                | 0.89 |
| Rev (all-time) ↔ MRR         | 0.87 |
| Rev 30D ↔ Active subs        | 0.82 |
| Rev (all-time) ↔ Active subs | 0.78 |
| Rev 30D ↔ Rev/visitor        | 0.65 |

| Weakest / surprising        | ρ     |
|-----------------------------|-------|
| Rev (all-time) ↔ MRR growth | -0.05 |
| Active subs ↔ Rev growth    | 0.05  |
| MRR ↔ MRR growth            | 0.03  |
| Visitors ↔ Rev growth       | 0.03  |
| X followers ↔ MRR growth    | -0.03 |

**SO WHAT** Everything that predicts revenue is a measure of customers; nothing that predicts revenue is a measure of attention.

# Three conclusions the correlation matrix forces on us

## Customers, not clicks

- $\text{MRR} \leftrightarrow \text{subscriptions } \rho 0.90 \cdot \text{revenue} \leftrightarrow \text{subscriptions } \rho 0.78$
- $\text{Followers} \leftrightarrow \text{revenue only } \rho 0.23$ ;  $\text{DR} \leftrightarrow \text{growth} \approx 0.01$
- Underwrite customer counts; discount audience claims

## Growth is orthogonal

- $\text{Growth} \leftrightarrow \text{MRR } \rho 0.07 \cdot \text{growth} \leftrightarrow \text{visitors } \rho 0.03$
- Revenue growth and MRR growth correlate only  $\rho 0.38$  with each other
- Momentum must be verified per company; it cannot be inferred from any other field

## Monetisation is a choice

- $\text{Revenue/visitor} \leftrightarrow \text{revenue } \rho 0.57$  — pricing power scales with success
- $\text{Traffic} \leftrightarrow \text{revenue } \rho 0.60$  but only for the 18% who report
- Two firms with identical traffic can differ 100x in revenue

**SO WHAT** A three-variable underwriting model — subscriptions, ARPU and verified 30-day growth — explains more of this market than any amount of traffic or social analysis.

# Twenty-seven investable observations (1–9 of 27)

## 01 Hidden gems

110 startups earn >\$3k MRR with <200 followers and DR<20 — cash flow the market cannot see.

## 02 Anonymity premium

Anonymised listings ('Stealth Company') hold a median MRR far above the market — the biggest sellers hide, so screen them in, not out.

## 03 Growth is free

Implied multiple vs growth correlation is -0.01: buying momentum costs nothing today.

## 04 The free-tier tax

Freemium medians \$126 MRR vs \$1,024 for pure paid — an 8x self-inflicted discount.

## 05 Mobile IAP trap

77 mobile apps hold the most subscriptions and the least ARPU (\$3.42) — scale without economics.

## 06 B2B pricing power

B2B ARPU \$49 vs B2C \$9.34; the same engineering effort earns 5x more pointed at businesses.

## 07 Persona beats product

E-commerce buyers pay \$11.3k median MRR; indie founders pay \$77 — a 147x spread on buyer choice alone.

## 08 Category contrarianism

AI holds 20% of firms and a median MRR 79% below Education's.

## 09 Exceptional monetisation

Laper converts 16 monthly visitors into \$24k — \$1,503 per visitor; high-touch AI beats volume funnels.



## Twenty-seven investable observations (10–18 of 27)

### 10 Revenue without traffic

Six firms clear \$10k+ monthly revenue on under 2,000 visits — proof that distribution can be entirely outbound.

### 11 The zero-growth majority

31% of firms are exactly flat: stable, boring, and ideal roll-up targets at low multiples.

### 12 Decline is common

34% are shrinking — always price in a negative-growth base case for the median asset.

### 13 Provider as a screen

Superwall firms carry a \$7,337 median MRR — a 19-company shortlist worth a full pass.

### 14 Stripe monoculture

95% of lifetime revenue flows through Stripe; a Stripe-only diligence toolkit covers the whole market.

### 15 Payback maths

Median listed asset: \$35k ask on \$1,055 MRR — a 33-month payback; only sub-2x deals clear a 2-year hurdle.

### 16 Stated multiples mislead

Median stated 2.3x vs 4.8x recomputed — sellers quote the friendlier denominator.

### 17 Pre-revenue clutter

47 listings quote a 0.0x multiple; excluding them changes the market's apparent price level completely.

### 18 Sub-1x opportunities

Eight listings sit below 1x trailing revenue with live MRR — the shortest payback in the file.

# Twenty-seven investable observations (19–27 of 27)

## 19 The Estonia/Singapore arbitrage

Non-US firms with US-level median MRR (\$1,024–\$2,126) at lower founder price expectations.

## 20 India volume trap

59 Indian startups, median MRR \$6 — count without monetisation; avoid volume-driven geographic theses.

## 21 Run-rate acceleration

66% of trading firms are running above their trailing-12M pace — the market is expanding, not decaying.

## 22 Revenue quality split

62% recurring-heavy vs 12% one-time-heavy: two asset classes needing two different multiples.

## 23 Subscription arithmetic

ARPU is tight (\$20–50 B2B); MRR upside comes from logo count, so distribution beats pricing experiments.

## 24 Enterprise paradox

'Contact Sales' firms have the highest ARPU and negative median growth — pricing power without pipeline.

## 25 Recruiting & HR momentum

+61% median growth on a 6-firm base — smallest, fastest cohort; a thematic worth early positioning.

## 26 Marketing double win

Marketing is top-3 in both total revenue (\$34m) and median MRR (\$1,586) — the only large, healthy category.

## 27 Concentration risk

Removing one company (Stan) removes 23% of the market's lifetime revenue — never benchmark against dataset totals.

**SO WHAT** Every insight above is a filter we can run again next month against the live marketplace — the edge is process, not a one-off snapshot.

07

# Investment memo

---

The ten bets and fifteen recommendations

## If I were investing in this dataset, these are the patterns I would bet on

- 1 Revenue is a top-decile phenomenon: 100 firms hold 91% of it — source narrow, not wide.
- 2 Growth is free at the point of sale: multiples ignore momentum ( $r = -0.01$ ).
- 3 B2B out-earns B2C by 5.7x on MRR and 5.2x on ARPU, at the same build cost.
- 4 Pricing architecture is worth 8x: paid subscription \$1,024 median MRR vs freemium \$126.
- 5 Customers — not audience — drive revenue: subscriptions  $\rho$  0.90, followers  $\rho$  0.23.
- 6 The median listed asset is a 33-month payback; only disciplined sub-2x buying beats a 24-month hurdle.
- 7 62% of trading revenue is genuinely recurring — the asset class is real, but 12% is one-time and must be discounted.
- 8 110 profitable-but-invisible firms have zero SEO or social footprint: acquirable upside sits in the unexploited channel.
- 9 Category crowding (AI: 20% of firms) is inversely related to monetisation; the money is in Education, Marketing, Analytics.
- 10 One company is 23% of the market — every dataset-level average is unusable; medians are the only honest benchmark.

**The bet: buy flat-to-growing B2B micro-SaaS at 1–3x trailing revenue, remove the free tier, and consolidate distribution.**

# Five strategic recommendations

**R1****Run a buy-and-fix roll-up, not a venture portfolio**

Target 15–25 assets at \$2–20k MRR, 1–3x revenue, with a shared pricing and growth playbook.

**R2****Anchor the mandate on B2B SaaS and e-commerce tooling**

These segments carry 5x the ARPU at the same acquisition cost; exclude generic consumer apps.

**R3****Institutionalise the 'growth is free' arbitrage**

Standing screen: listings with &gt;20% verified 30-day growth priced below 5x — re-run monthly.

**R4****Treat revenue quality as a pricing input**

Two multiple bands: recurring-heavy assets up to 3.0x, one-time-heavy capped at 1.2x.

**R5****Build the thesis on medians and cohorts**

Ban dataset averages from investment committee materials; one outlier moves them by 23%.

# Five operational recommendations

**R1****Kill the free tier in the first 90 days**

Freemium-to-paid conversion is the single largest observed value gap (8x median MRR).

**R2****Re-price to B2B ARPU benchmarks**

Move acquired products from the \$9 consumer point toward the \$34–49 B2B band with grandfathering.

**R3****Diligence customers, not revenue**

Require subscription count, churn cohort and ARPU history; MRR alone hides a 90%-correlated proxy.

**R4****Standardise on Stripe billing**

95% of the market's revenue already runs there; one integration serves the whole portfolio's reporting.

**R5****Instrument analytics on day one**

82% of firms cannot report traffic — the acquirer who measures conversion immediately owns an information edge.

# Five growth recommendations

**R1****Harvest the SEO vacuum**

Median domain rating is 10; content and programmatic SEO on acquired assets is an uncontested channel.

**R2****Shift acquired B2C assets toward B2B use cases**

Same product, business buyer, 5x ARPU — the fastest revenue lever short of re-pricing.

**R3****Cross-sell across the portfolio**

Shared personas (marketing teams, e-commerce operators) let one CAC serve several products.

**R4****Prioritise Education, Marketing and Analytics for new bets**

Highest median MRR with the least founder crowding.

**R5****Add outbound to high-ARPU, low-traffic assets**

Companies earning \$10k+ on <2,000 visits prove sales-led motion works better than funnel scale here.

# Methodology, assumptions and limitations

- Source: single frozen extract of the TrustMRR universe, 1,000 rows × 29 fields, dated 30 July 2026. Pivot sheets in the workbook were ignored; all analysis re-derived from the raw 'Data' sheet.
- All monetary values are treated as USD as labelled; no FX conversion or inflation adjustment applied.
- Medians are the headline statistic throughout. Means are reported only where explicitly labelled and are winsorised for growth at [-100%, +1,000%].
- Implied multiple = asking price ÷ trailing-12-month revenue, recomputed independently of the marketplace's stated 'x'. Listings with zero revenue are excluded from multiple statistics (n=243 of 262 usable).
- Correlations are Spearman rank correlations, chosen because every monetary variable is heavily skewed; they measure monotonic association, not causation.
- Category, persona, pricing and audience segmentation rely on free-text fields with 27–36% missingness; segment-level conclusions are directional and stated with n.
- Traffic and revenue-per-visitor are self-reported by 17.8% of firms and are almost certainly upward-biased; no imputation was performed.
- Company-level call-outs are screening candidates, not investment recommendations, and are subject to code, churn, contract and ownership diligence.

*Prepared for investment committee discussion · figures as at 30 July 2026*